[INCH-POUND]

A-A-2658
January 10, 1991

COMMERCIAL ITEM DESCRIPTION
BINDER, LOOSE-LEAF,
(WITH OR WITHOUT FLEXIBLE PRONG)

The General Services Administration has authorized the use of this commercial item description in preference to Federal Specification UU-B-335 which has been cancelled.

This specification covers loose leaf binders made of pressboard and equipped with or without metal prong fastener and compressor, for use in containing paper.

Classification

Binders covered by this description shall be of the following types and classes as specified (see Section 7):

Type I. High density, nonprinting grade
  Class I. Without metal prong fastener and compressor
  Class II. With metal prong fastener and compressor

Type II. Medium density, nonprinting grade
  Class I. Without metal prong fastener and compressor
  Class II. With metal prong fastener and compressor

1. Salient Characteristics

A. The binder cover and binder stick shall be made of Type I or Type II pressboard as defined in section 2 when tested with the appropriate test method. Unless specified (see Section 7), the supplier may provide either Type pressboard.

B. The hinge assembly shall consist of cloth glued to a binding stick and shall have 1/4 inch holes spaced 2-3/4, 4-1/4, 5-1/2, 7, or 8-1/2 inches apart, equidistant from the center of the hinge and approximate center of the width (determined visually) of the binding stick. The cloth shall overlap the binding stick and shall be glued to each side of the binder cover over a width of not less than 1/2 inch. The distance between the binder cover and the stick shall be sufficient to permit flexing without interference. The hinge length shall be the same as the length of the binder.

C. The cloth hinge shall have a thread count of not less than 60 threads in the warp, and not less than 50 threads in the filling direction. The cloth hinge shall have an Elmendorf tearing strength of not less than 70 gms (direct reading) in the long direction of the binder. The color of the

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cloth shall be brown, for red pressboard; and, black for all other color pressboard.

D. Two assemblies, as described, shall be furnished as a unit, joined by a metal prong fastener and compressor.

E. The metal prong fastener with compressor shall conform to the requirements of Commercial Item Description A-A-407 and shall be suitable for the hole spacings of 2-3/4, 4-1/4, 5-1/2, 7, or 8-1/2 inches. The length of the prongs shall be suitable for the capacities specified.

F. All corners of the nonbinding side shall be rounded.

G. The binder shall accommodate sheet sizes as specified. (See Section 7).

H. The outer dimensions of the binder shall be at least 1/2 inch larger than the sheet dimension.

I. The binder shall have a capacity of 1, 2, 3, 4, 5, or 6 inches as specified. (See Section 7)

Workmanship. All edges and surfaces shall be smooth and the binder shall be free from any defects and imperfections which may affect appearance or serviceability.

2. Tables and Test Methods

	Type I	Type II	Test Method
Thickness #	0.020 inch	0.025 inch	TAPPI T 411
Basis Weight 24 x 36 in. - 500 sheets	470 pounds ± 5%	480 pounds ± 5%	TAPPI T 410
Bursting Strength (minimum)	220 points	250 points	TAPPI T 403

- A tolerance of - 0.0010 inch and + 0.0015 inch is allowed.

3. Quality Assurance

Responsibility for Inspection. Unless otherwise specified in the contract or purchase order, the supplier is responsible for the performance of all inspection requirements as specified herein. Except as otherwise specified, the supplier may utilize his own facilities or any commercial laboratory acceptable to the Government. The Government reserves the right to perform any of the inspections set forth in the Commercial Item Description, where such inspections are deemed necessary to assure that supplies and services conform to the prescribed requirements (See Section 7, Ordering Data).

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Each lot of binders shall be inspected for conformance to the requirements herein. Sampling for inspection shall be in accordance with MIL-STD-105 using the plans specified below.

A. Sampling for visual examination - Inspection Level S-4 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one binder.

B. Sampling for dimensional examination - Inspection Level S-4 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one binder.

C. Sampling for testing - Inspection Level S-4 with an Acceptable Quality Level (AQL) of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one binder.

D. Packaging, Packing, and Marking - Inspection Level S-2 with an AQL of 4.0 percent defective. The sample unit shall be one fully prepared shipping container.

4. Application for copies of technical documents referenced herein: The issue date in effect on date of invitation for bids or request for proposal shall apply.

Commercial Item Description A-A-407 is available from General Services Administration Business Service Centers in Boston, MA; New York, NY; Washington, DC; Atlanta, GA; Chicago, IL; Kansas City, MO; Fort Worth, TX; Denver, CO; San Francisco, CA; Los Angeles, CA; and Auburn, WA.

TAPPI standard test methods can be obtained from Technical Association of the Pulp and Paper Industry; Technology Park/Atlanta; P.O. Box 105113; Atlanta, GA 30348.

Military Specifications are available from Naval Publications and Forms Center; 5801 Tabor Avenue; Philadelphia, PA 19120.

5. Preparation for delivery

Packaging and packing of the binders shall be as specified in the contract or purchase order.

6. Recovered materials

The manufacturer shall utilize recovered materials to the maximum extent practicable.

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7. Notes

A. Ordering Data

Purchasers should specify the following in procurement documents:

(1) Type and Class.
(2) Thickness of the pressboard.
(3) Color of binder.
(4) Spacing of metal fastener.
(5) Sheet size and capacity of binder.
(6) Packaging, packing and marking.

B. Item Identifiers/Reference Part Number System (For Cataloging Use Only)

AA2658 - A 1 : This example describes a loose leaf binder, high density, nonprinting grade without metal prong fastener and compressor.

---1 - Class I - Without metal prong fastener and compressor
2 - Class II - With metal prong fastener and compressor

------A - Type I - High density, nonprinting grade
B - Type II - Medium density, nonprinting grade

DOD has waived coordination interest.

Preparing Activity

GSA/FSS

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